PHISHING AWARENESS TRAINING

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PHISHING AWARENESS

Protect Yourself from Online Scams

This training will help you understand how phishing works, how attackers trick users, and how you can stay safe in real-world situations.

WHAT IS PHISHING?

Phishing is a cyber attack where criminals pretend to be trusted organizations (banks, companies, government agencies) to steal sensitive information.

They typically try to collect:

- Login credentials (usernames & passwords)
- Credit/debit card details
- Personal identity information

Phishing attacks rely more on human mistakes than technical hacking.

COMMON TYPES OF PHISHING

- Email Phishing – Mass emails sent to many users pretending to be legitimate
- Spear Phishing – Highly targeted attacks using personal information
- Smishing – Fake messages sent via SMS (e.g., OTP scams)
- Vishing – Fraudulent phone calls pretending to be support agents

Attackers choose methods based on what’s easiest to trick you.

HOW TO RECOGNIZE PHISHING EMAILS

Carefully examine emails before trusting them:

- Check the sender's email (e.g., support@paypa1.com instead of paypal.com)
- Look for generic greetings like "Dear Customer"
- Watch for urgent language pressuring you to act quickly
- Be cautious of unexpected attachments or links
- Notice poor spelling, grammar, or formatting

Always think: "Is this message trying to rush or scare me?"

EXAMPLE OF A PHISHING EMAIL

Subject: Urgent: Account Suspension Notice
"Your account will be suspended within 24 hours unless you verify your details immediately. Click the link below to secure your account."
⚠ Red Flags:

- Creates panic (urgency)
- Suspicious link (may lead to fake website)
- Requests sensitive information

Tip: Hover over links to preview the real URL before clicking.

RECOGNIZING FAKE WEBSITES

Fake websites are designed to look real but steal your data.

How to identify them:

- Check for HTTPS (but don’t rely only on it)
- Look closely at the domain name (e.g., amaz0n.com)
- Poor design or broken elements
- Unusual pop-ups asking for sensitive info
- Lack of proper contact or support information

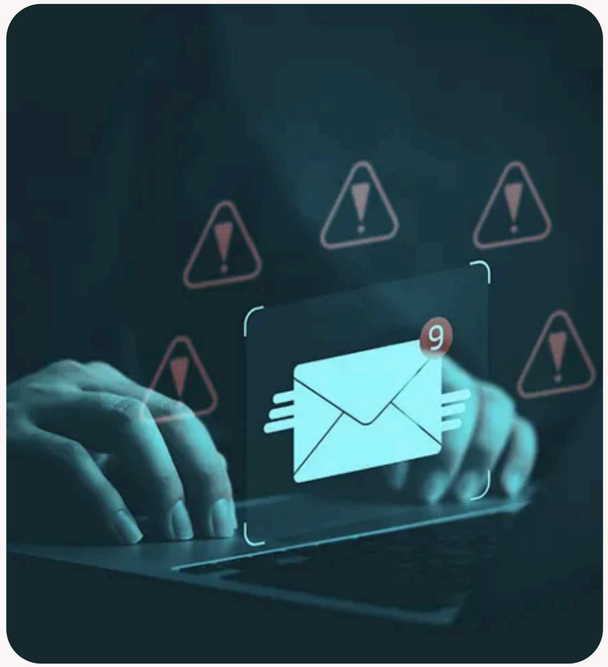
When in doubt, manually type the official website URL.

SOCIAL ENGINEERING TACTICS

Phishing attacks use psychological tricks:

- Fear: “Your account will be locked”
- Urgency: “Act now or lose access”
- Authority: Pretending to be bank/HR/admin
- Curiosity: “You’ve won a prize”
- Greed: “Claim your reward”

These tactics are designed to make you react without thinking.



REAL-WORLD EXAMPLE

During COVID-19, attackers sent emails pretending to be from WHO and health organizations.

They included:

- Fake safety guidelines
- Malicious links
- Requests for login credentials

Impact:

- Thousands of users lost personal and financial data

Lesson: Always verify the source, even if it looks official.

BEST PRACTICES TO STAY SAFE

Follow these habits daily:

- Never click unknown or suspicious links
- Verify emails by contacting the organization directly
- Use strong and unique passwords for each account
- Enable Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA)
- Keep your system and apps updated
- Avoid using public Wi-Fi for sensitive transactions

Security is a habit, not a one-time action.

WHAT TO DO IF YOU SUSPECT PHISHING

Take immediate action:

- Do NOT click links or download attachments
- Report the email to IT or security team
- Mark the email as spam/phishing
- Delete the message
- Change your passwords if you interacted with it

Quick reporting can prevent larger attacks.

QUICK QUIZ

Q1: Which is a common phishing sign?

- A. Friendly tone
- B. Urgent request for action
- C. Known sender name

Q2: What should you do with suspicious links?

- A. Click to verify
- B. Ignore and report
- C. Forward to others

Q3: What is spear phishing?

- A. Random attack
- B. Targeted attack
- C. Phone scam

ANSWERS

Q1: B
Q2: B
Q3: B

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Think before you click
- Always verify the sender and links
- Do not share sensitive information easily
- Report suspicious activity immediately

Your awareness is the first line of defense.

THANK YOU